
MEETING MINUTES

March 18, 2024

Executive Session: 5:15 PM

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - 6/1
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Executive Session

Executive session pursuant to G.L c. 30A (a) (3): the Medford School Committee will convene in Executive Session to discuss strategy in preparation for negotiations with **Medford Educational Secretaries (AFSCME Council 93)**, because an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining position of the Committee and the Chair so declares.

Executive session pursuant to G.L c. 30A (a) (3): the Medford School Committee will convene in Executive Session to discuss strategy in preparation for negotiations with **Teamsters Local 25 Custodians**, because an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining position of the Committee and the Chair so declares.

Motion to enter Executive Session by Member Graham, second by Member Branley - 6/0/1 passes

Executive Session started at 5:20 PM

Reconvene regular meeting at 6:27 PM

7/0 in attendance at reconvene

- IV. Consent Agenda
 - Bills and Payrolls
 - Regular School Committee Minutes, **March 4, 2024**
 - Special Meeting of the School Committee, **February 28, 2024**
 - Committee of the Whole Meeting, **March 13, 2024**

Motion to Approve by Member Branley, second by Member Olapade - 7/0 passes

- V. Report of Subcommittees - NONE
- VI. Report of the Superintendent
 - 1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
 - Farewell and words of appreciation to Melanie McLaughlin who recently resigned as School committee member
 - Welcome to new School Committee member John Intoppa

2. **Recommendation to Approve Donations** from the Jae S. Lim Foundation and Mabbett and Associates - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Motion to approve donation by Jae S. Lim Foundation and Mabbett and Associates by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passes

3. **Recommendation to Approve** Medford as a No School Choice District for SY 24-25 - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Motion to approve Medford as a No School Choice District for SY 24-25 by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passes

4. **Report on the Resolution of the FY2024 Potential Budget Shortfall** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Motion to request an update for what deferred spending looks like for FY 25 by Member Branley, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passes

Ellie O'Leary
30 Norwich Circle
Union Secretary and teacher

Joanne McKay
Non-Medford Resident
Financial secretary of Union and teacher

- Member Graham suggested watching the Committee of the Whole Meeting from March 13, 2024 for anyone needing more detailed information on the budget as it stands currently.

5. **Social and Emotional Learning (SEL) Update** - Stacey Schulman, Director of School Counseling and Behavioral Health

6. **English Learner (EL) Update and Enrollment Report** - Paul Teixeira, Director of ELL and Title III

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm) - NONE

VII. Continued Business - NONE

VIII. New Business

2024-11 Submitted by Member Ruseau, Member Graham and Member Olapade

*Resolution in Support of Massachusetts Association of School Committees Resolutions
Reaffirmation*

Whereas the Massachusetts Association of School Committees (MASC) ByLaws Article IX section I requires adopted resolutions of the association to expire three years after adoption;

Whereas the MASC ByLaws Article IX section I requires member School Committees to vote for the readoption of expiring resolutions for consideration at the annual conference; and

Whereas the following resolutions are matters the Medford School Committee has previously supported. Now, therefore, be it:

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. reaffirm support for the following resolutions:
 - Access to Menstrual Supplies (2019)
 - Mandatory Recess in Public Schools (2021)
 - Prohibiting the use of Native American Mascots (2021)
 - Climate Change (2019)
 - Poverty and Children (2019)
 - Charter School Reform (2019);
2. requests the Secretary of the Medford School Committee convey to the MASC Resolutions Committee Chair our support for the above resolutions being reaffirmed; and
3. Requests the Secretary of the Medford School Committee engage with the MASC Resolutions Committee and other Massachusetts School Committees as necessary to reaffirm the above resolutions pursuant to the ByLaws of the MASC.

Date Submitted: March 7, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: March 18, 2024

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Olapade - 7/0 passes

2024 - 12 Submitted by Member Ruseau

Policy BBBA/BBBB - SCHOOL COMMITTEE MEMBER QUALIFICATIONS/OATH OF OFFICE will be updated with the following language:

To serve on the School Committee, an individual must be a registered voter in the city or town from which they are elected or appointed and must take an oath of office as required by law.

Each new member will present to the Committee secretary official certification of having sworn the oath before the City Clerk before entering on their official duties as a member of the Committee.

From the Superintendent, newly qualified Committee members, by law, will receive and sign a receipt of a copy of the Massachusetts open meeting law governing the conduct of Committee meetings in general and executive sessions in particular.

Newly qualified Committee members shall, by law, receive and sign a receipt for, within 30 days of taking office, a copy of the Massachusetts Ethics Commission's Summary of the Conflict of Interest laws. As municipal employees, all School Committee members shall receive a copy of said summary annually. All School Committee members shall, within 30 days of taking office and every 2 years thereafter, complete the Massachusetts Ethics Commission's online training program. Upon completing the online training program, members shall provide notice of such completion to be retained for 6 years by the Superintendent.

Established by law.

Policy Information

First Adopted: Unknown

Last Amended: TBD

Last Reviewed: not reviewed

Review Frequency: ten (10) years

Next Review: TBD

Version: 2

Policy ID: BBBA/BBBB

Original Source: MASC, Updated 2022

Legal References: M.G.L. 30A:20; 41:1; 41:107; 76:5; 268A:27-28

Date Submitted: March 10, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: March 18, 2024

Motion to waive first reading by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passes

Motion to approve updated policy as outlined with review by City Clerk by Member Graham, second by Member Olapade - 7/0 passes

2024-13 Submitted by Member Reinfeld

Whereas the public has a right to view meetings during and after their occurrence and whereas both Medford Public Schools and Medford Community Media currently provide online access to meetings:

Be it resolved that the school committee meeting pages on the Medford Public Schools website will include a link to archived recordings of public Medford School Committee meetings*, and that individual recording links, when available, will be posted along with past meeting minutes, whose posting is described by policy BEDG.

Be it further resolved that meeting notifications, described by policy BEDA, will include information about non-participatory real-time viewing options via local access television (e.g., Comcast channel 8, Verizon channel 45) and streaming services (e.g., Medford Community Media video on demand, Medford Public Schools YouTube) along with individual Zoom access links.

This resolution is offered with the goal of making Medford School Committee meetings more accessible to members of the Medford community.

* Links:

Medford Community Media's video on demand page: <https://medford.vod.castus.tv/vod>

Medford Public Schools YouTube account:

<https://www.youtube.com/@medfordpublicschools464>

Date Submitted: March 12, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: March 18, 2024

Motion to approve as amended to include YouTube and MCM links on agenda by Member Intoppa, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passes

2024-14 Submitted by Member Ruseau, Member Graham, and Member Olapade

Resolution in Support of a Stabilization Fund for the City of Medford

Whereas the use of Free Cash is only possible for a few months each year, from when Free Cash is certified by the State through June 30th, when the fiscal year ends;

Whereas the Medford Public Schools may experience unexpected expenses not planned for in the budget cycle, such as major equipment failures, floods, fires, etc.;

Whereas Medford Public Schools cannot borrow money to cover such expenses;

Whereas at present, the only mechanism for Medford Public Schools to receive additional funding to cover unexpected expenses is by a supplemental appropriation submitted by the Mayor to the City Council for approval;

Whereas the inability to use Free Cash for much of the year places the Medford Public Schools and the City of Medford, in a precarious position should a supplemental appropriation be required to ensure educational continuity for our students;

Whereas a Stabilization Fund provides a mechanism for the allocation and spending of money throughout the year; and

Whereas the use of Stabilization Fund resources requires a Mayoral request to the City Council for approval; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. thanks the Medford City Council for approving the creation of a Stabilization Fund;
2. urges the Medford City Council, when a request to add funds to the Stabilization Fund is received, to approve the request before the expiration of Free Cash; and
3. requests the Superintendent of Schools send this resolution and a record of the vote of the School Committee to the Medford City Council.

Date Submitted: March 13, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: March 18, 2024

Motion to approve by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 5/1/1 passes

2024-15 Submitted by Member Ruseau, Member Graham, and Member Olapade

Whereas the Resolution on the Disciplinary Practice of Suspension was unanimously adopted by the Medford School Committee on October 14, 2020;

Whereas the language of the Resolution on the Disciplinary Practice of Suspension provides that the following actions will be taken by Medford Public Schools:

- ends the use of out-of-school suspensions effective the first day of the school year 2021 except as provided by law;
- provides for the continuation of a learning environment for every in-school suspension;
- ensures that in-school suspensions will not occur in isolation without instruction or rehabilitative counseling;
- selects alternative tools for use in discipline, such as restorative justice wherever possible;
- will complete a comprehensive program review of disciplinary practices across the district including but not limited to, system-wide disciplinary measures, reporting to

the school committee, social and emotional supports for victims, as well as establishing a staff feedback process to be presented to the School Committee in May of 2021;

- seeks to incorporate any funding requirements to ensure the implementation of the selected alternative(s) with fidelity in the next budget cycle; and
- establishes an annual reporting process that includes but is not limited to, system-wide disciplinary measures reporting to the school committee as well as establishing staff feedback process;

Whereas it appears that there are occurrences of non-compliance with the policy happening in the district, and that occurrences have been observed since the effective date of the policy; and

Whereas the annual reporting requirements of the resolution have not occurred; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, that the Superintendent will:

1. provide a description of the onboarding process that ensures district staff, including teachers, vice principals, and principals, are apprised of this policy;
2. provide a report of training available to all staff, including staff participation in training offered, disaggregated by building;
3. provide a detailed report of disciplinary actions taken from the start of the 2023-2024 school year through March 1, 2024. The report provided should be a model to comply with the annual reporting requirement going forward and will contain the following minimum data:
 - types of incidents, determinations, and discipline
 - the above data elements summarized for the district
 - the above data elements disaggregated by school, by grade level, and by school and grade level
4. provide a description of how central administration determines compliance with this policy;
5. provide a report of the number of times the above policy has not been followed by building leadership and what actions are being taken to remedy these instances of non-compliance;
6. conduct a review of all suspensions from the start of the 2023-2024 school year through March 1, 2024, and provide an assessment of how many suspensions were inappropriate; and
7. provide the information requested above at the April 8, 2024 School Committee meeting.

Date Submitted: March 13, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: March 18, 2024

Mary Davis

In person

Daughter is current high school student

Speaking on handling of suspensions

Motion to approve as amended to add “by DESE reporting categories”, add a bullet under #3 “the number of times MPS has filed police reports and the number of students impacted by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passes

2024-16 Submitted by Member Graham

Be it resolved that the administration will present proposed FY25 rate cards for all tuition and fee-based programs and rentals for review and approval by the School Committee, which may include but is not limited to Pool usage, facility rentals, athletic user fees, pre-school, MEEP, and Kids Corner. Be it further resolved that the reviews will occur as available but no later than June 30, 2024 for the upcoming fiscal year.

Date Submitted: March 13, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: March 18, 2024

Motion to approve as amended by historical record of 3 years by Member Graham, seconded by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passes

IX. Reports Requested

X. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Joseph Rossetti**, Assistant Coach of the Mustang Football Team.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **James Byrnes**, former Medford High School teacher and Junior Varsity Boys Basketball coach.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Margaret Kinslow**, mother of Jane King, administrative assistant at Medford High School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Mary Jodice**, wife of the late Paul Jodice, former teacher at Medford High School.

XI. Next Meeting

April 8, 2024 - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XII. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Ruseau, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passes

Meeting adjourned at 8:50 pm